

Sleep Health and Lifestyle: A Data-Driven Project Proposal

Alper Şen

GEBZE TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY, DATA SCIENCE AND ANALYTICS

a.sen2025@gtu.edu.tr

ABSTRACT Sleep health is a fundamental component of overall well-being, influencing physical health, mental stability, and daily performance. In recent years, lifestyle-related factors such as stress, physical activity, body mass index (BMI), occupation, and age have been increasingly associated with sleep quality, duration, and the prevalence of sleep disorders. This project proposes a data-driven analysis of sleep health and lifestyle factors using exploratory data analysis and statistical methods to uncover meaningful patterns and relationships. Building upon preliminary insights, the study examines correlations between sleep quality and stress levels, the occupational impact of sleep duration, the relationship between physical activity and BMI categories, and the distribution of sleep disorders across age and BMI groups. In addition to descriptive analysis, the project outlines how these data can be extended toward predictive machine learning models for sleep quality and sleep disorder risk estimation. The expected outcome is a comprehensive analytical framework that supports both individual-level recommendations and population-level health insights. Ultimately, this work aims to demonstrate how data science methodologies can contribute to improved sleep health awareness, preventive healthcare strategies, and future intelligent health monitoring systems.

INDEX TERMS Sleep health, lifestyle factors, data science, exploratory data analysis, machine learning, health analytics.

I. INTRODUCTION

Sleep is a critical biological process that supports cognitive function, emotional regulation, metabolic balance, and immune system performance. Despite its importance, sleep health is often compromised by modern lifestyle habits, including high stress levels, sedentary behavior, irregular work schedules, and poor health management. Insufficient or low-quality sleep has been linked to chronic conditions such as obesity, cardiovascular disease, diabetes, and mental health disorders.

With the increasing availability of health-related data, data science provides powerful tools to analyze complex relationships between sleep and lifestyle factors. Rather than treating sleep as an isolated behavior, a data-driven perspective

allows researchers to study sleep health as part of an interconnected system involving stress, physical activity, BMI, age, and occupational demands. This project focuses on analyzing these interdependencies to generate actionable insights that can inform healthier lifestyle choices and future intelligent health systems.

II. PROBLEM STATEMENT AND OBJECTIVE

The primary problem addressed in this project is the lack of integrated, data-driven understanding of how multiple lifestyle factors collectively influence sleep health. While individual factors such as stress or physical activity have been studied independently, their combined effects and interactions are less frequently analyzed in a unified framework.

A. MAIN OBJECTIVE

The main objective of this project is to analyze the relationships between sleep health indicators and lifestyle variables using data science techniques, and to propose a scalable analytical framework that can later be extended with machine learning models for prediction and risk assessment.

B. MOTIVATION

Understanding these relationships can support early detection of sleep-related risks, promote healthier habits, and guide future digital health applications. From a data science perspective, sleep health represents a rich and socially impactful domain where analytical and predictive models can directly contribute to quality of life improvements.

III. DATA DESCRIPTION

The dataset used in this project consists of individual-level sleep and lifestyle metrics, including sleep quality, sleep duration, stress levels, physical activity (daily steps), BMI category, age, occupation, and reported sleep disorders such as insomnia and sleep apnea. The data structure enables both numerical and categorical analysis, making it suitable for correlation studies, group-based comparisons, and future supervised learning tasks.

Although the current study focuses on exploratory and statistical analysis, the dataset can be expanded with longitudinal data, wearable device measurements, or clinical indicators to support more advanced modeling approaches.

IV. METHODOLOGY

The methodology of this project follows a structured data science workflow:

1. **Data Collection and Preparation:** Cleaning missing values, standardizing numerical variables, and encoding categorical features.
2. **Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA):** Visual and statistical exploration of distributions, correlations, and group differences.
3. **Correlation Analysis:** Measuring linear relationships using Pearson correlation coefficients to identify strong associations.
4. **Group-Based Analysis:** Comparing sleep metrics across BMI categories, age groups, and occupational classes.
5. **Interpretation and Insight Generation:** Translating statistical findings into meaningful health-related interpretations.

The analysis reveals several key findings, such as a strong negative correlation between sleep quality and stress levels, non-linear relationships between physical activity and BMI, and age-related increases in sleep apnea prevalence.

V. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

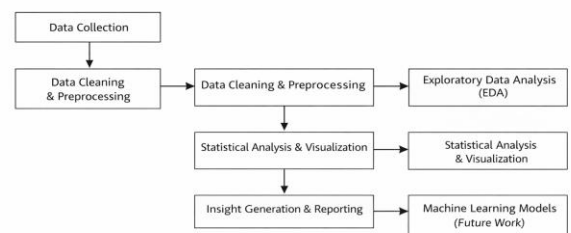


Fig. 1. System architecture of the proposed sleep health analysis framework.

The system architecture of this project represents an end-to-end analytical workflow designed to transform raw sleep and lifestyle data into actionable insights and predictive potential. The architecture is modular, allowing future extensions with minimal redesign.

Stage 1: Data Collection
Sleep and lifestyle data are collected from structured survey responses and health-related records, including variables such as sleep duration, sleep quality, stress level, physical activity (daily steps), BMI category, age, occupation, and reported sleep disorders.

Stage 2: Data Cleaning and Preprocessing
This stage includes handling missing values,

Stage 4: Statistical Analysis and Visualization
Correlation coefficients and group-based analyses are applied to quantify relationships such as sleep quality versus stress, BMI versus sleep disorders, and age versus sleep apnea prevalence.

Stage 5: Insight Generation and Reporting
Statistical results are translated into interpretable insights relevant to sleep health, lifestyle behavior, and public health implications.

Stage 6: Machine Learning Extension (Future Work)
Prepared datasets are fed into supervised and unsupervised learning models for prediction, classification, and clustering tasks.

This architecture can be visually represented in the report as a linear flow diagram progressing from data collection to predictive modeling.

VI. PRELIMINARY FINDINGS AND ANALYSIS

The exploratory and statistical analyses reveal several meaningful insights into the relationship between sleep health and lifestyle factors. A strong inverse relationship is observed between sleep quality and stress level, indicating that improved sleep quality is associated with reduced stress.

Physical activity levels are analyzed across BMI categories to assess lifestyle differences among population groups. **Figure 3** shows the average daily physical activity levels for normal,

removing inconsistencies, normalizing numerical features, and encoding categorical variables such as BMI category, occupation, and sleep disorder type.

Stage 3: Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA)
Descriptive statistics and visualizations are used to understand distributions, detect outliers, and identify initial relationships between variables.

overweight, and obese individuals. As illustrated in **Fig. 3**, physical activity levels remain similar for normal and overweight groups but decline sharply in the obese category, suggesting reduced mobility or lifestyle constraints.

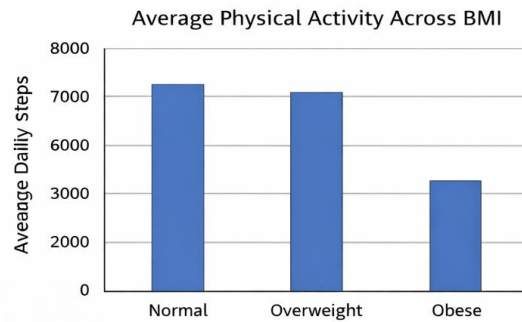


Fig. 3. Average daily physical activity across BMI categories.

Sleep disorder prevalence is further analyzed across age groups. **Figure 4** presents the distribution of sleep apnea prevalence by age. As shown in **Fig. 4**, sleep apnea prevalence increases noticeably with age, particularly after the age of 40, highlighting age as a significant risk factor.

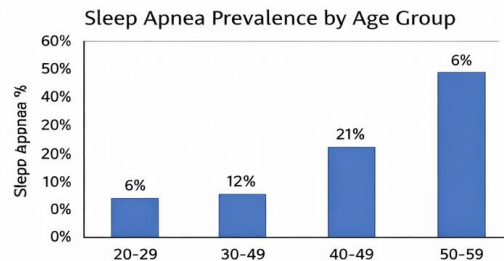


Fig. 4. Average daily physical activity across BMI categories.

VII. FUTURE WORK AND ML APPLICATIONS

While the current study focuses on exploratory and statistical analysis, the dataset is well-suited for advanced machine learning applications. Several future extensions are proposed below.

A. SLEEP QUALITY PREDICTION

One of the most direct extensions of this work is the development of predictive models for estimating sleep quality based on lifestyle and demographic factors. Supervised regression algorithms such as Linear Regression, Random Forest Regressors, Gradient Boosting Machines, and Support Vector Regression can be trained using input features including stress level, physical activity metrics, BMI category, age, and occupation. These models would allow the identification of the most influential predictors of sleep quality and provide quantitative estimates of expected sleep outcomes under different lifestyle conditions. Model performance could be evaluated using metrics such as Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE), Mean Absolute Error (MAE), and R^2 score to ensure reliability and interpretability.

B. SLEEP DISORDER RISK CLASSIFICATION

Another important application involves framing sleep disorder detection as a classification problem. Binary or multi-class classification models such as Logistic Regression, Decision Trees, Support Vector Machines, and Neural Networks can be employed to estimate the probability of conditions such as insomnia or sleep apnea. By learning patterns from labeled data, these models could support early risk identification and preventive intervention strategies. Such systems may be particularly valuable for identifying high-risk individuals within specific age or BMI groups, enabling targeted healthcare recommendations and resource allocation.

C. LIFESTYLE BASED CLUSTERING

Unsupervised learning techniques provide an opportunity to explore latent patterns within the

dataset without predefined labels. Clustering algorithms such as K-Means, DBSCAN, and Hierarchical Clustering can be applied to group individuals based on shared sleep and lifestyle characteristics. This approach may reveal distinct profiles, such as high-stress poor sleepers, physically active optimal sleepers, or sedentary individuals with elevated sleep disorder risk. These profiles can help researchers and practitioners better understand population heterogeneity and design group-specific intervention strategies.

D. PERSONALIZED RECOMMENDATION SYSTEMS

By combining predictive models with optimization techniques, personalized lifestyle recommendations can be generated to improve sleep outcomes. Such systems could be integrated into mobile health applications or wearable Technologies

These machine learning extensions transform the project from descriptive analysis into a scalable decision-support framework for intelligent health systems.

VIII. EXPECTED RESULTS AND BENEFITS

The expected results of this project extend beyond basic descriptive statistics and aim to provide a comprehensive, interpretable, and extensible framework for understanding sleep health through data-driven methods. From an analytical perspective, the project is expected to yield clear quantitative evidence of how lifestyle factors such as stress level, physical activity, BMI category, age, and occupation interact with key sleep health indicators including sleep quality, sleep duration, and sleep disorder prevalence.

One of the primary expected outcomes is the identification of statistically meaningful relationships between sleep quality and stress level, supported by visual and correlation-based analysis. These findings are expected to reinforce existing sleep health literature while providing dataset-specific insights that can be generalized to similar population-level studies. Additionally, group-based comparisons across BMI and age

categories are expected to reveal non-linear patterns, such as threshold effects in physical activity levels and age-related increases in sleep apnea prevalence. Such results help move beyond simple averages and contribute to a more nuanced understanding of sleep health dynamics.

From a practical standpoint, the project is expected to demonstrate how exploratory data analysis and visualization can translate raw health-related data into actionable insights. These insights can support individual-level awareness by highlighting lifestyle behaviors associated with poor sleep outcomes, such as high stress or low physical activity. At the same time, the results can inform population-level health strategies by identifying high-risk groups that may benefit from targeted interventions.

IX. CONCLUSION

This project presents a comprehensive data-driven investigation into the relationship between sleep health and lifestyle factors, demonstrating how data science methodologies can be effectively applied to a complex and socially significant health domain. By integrating exploratory data analysis, statistical evaluation, visualization techniques, and a forward-looking machine learning perspective, the study provides both analytical depth and practical relevance.

Through the analysis, the project highlights that sleep health is not determined by a single factor, but rather emerges from the interaction of multiple lifestyle variables such as stress level, physical activity, BMI category, age, and occupational demands. The findings reinforce the critical role of stress as a key determinant of sleep quality, while also revealing meaningful group-based patterns related to physical activity levels and sleep disorder prevalence.

These insights emphasize the multidimensional nature of sleep health and the importance of adopting holistic analytical approaches rather than isolated evaluations. Rather than focusing on a single variable, the study demonstrates that meaningful sleep health analysis requires the joint consideration of behavioral, physiological, and

demographic factors. This perspective aligns with contemporary health analytics research, which increasingly emphasizes system-level understanding over fragmented analysis.

Beyond the immediate analytical findings, one of the most significant contributions of this project is the establishment of a structured and scalable analytical framework. The proposed system architecture and methodological pipeline demonstrate how raw health-related data can be systematically transformed into interpretable insights and prepared for advanced analytical and predictive tasks.

This framework is not limited to the current dataset and can be extended to incorporate additional data sources such as wearable devices, longitudinal health records, or clinical indicators, thereby increasing its relevance for real-world applications. Furthermore, the discussion of potential machine learning extensions bridges the gap between descriptive analysis and intelligent decision-support systems, enabling early risk detection, personalized lifestyle recommendations, and data-driven preventive healthcare strategies.

In conclusion, this project demonstrates that data science provides powerful tools for understanding and improving sleep health at both individual and population levels. By combining rigorous analysis, clear visualization, and future-oriented modeling, the study contributes to the broader vision of smarter, more proactive, and more personalized health systems capable of addressing modern lifestyle-related health challenges.

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